



Ask A Question,
Save A Life.

QUESTION. PERSUADE. REFER.



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Pre-Training Survey



For many people, talking about suicide is not easy.

Some of us may be loss survivors, or attempt survivors.

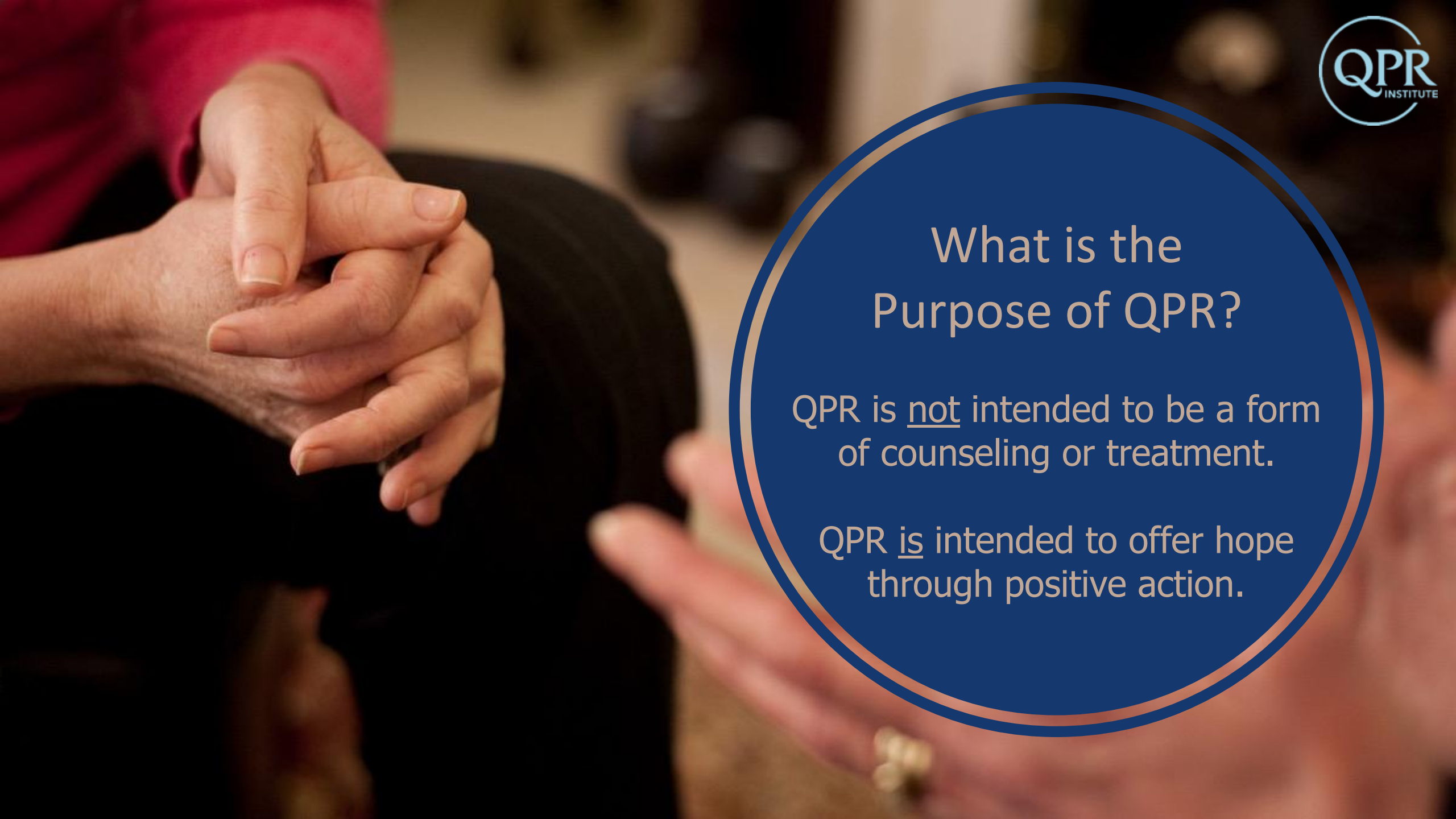
Please monitor yourself closely and seek help if needed.

988 SUICIDE & CRISIS
LIFELINE

Learning Objectives

- Increase awareness of stigma and understand suicide as a public health issue
- How to recognize someone at risk for suicide
- How to Question, Persuade and Refer someone who may be suicidal
- How to access local and national referral resources
- How to offer hope, and save a life



The background of the slide is a blurred photograph of several pairs of hands. Some hands are clasped together, while others are open and gesturing, suggesting a group of people in a supportive or therapeutic setting.

What is the Purpose of QPR?

QPR is not intended to be a form of counseling or treatment.

QPR is intended to offer hope through positive action.



Introduction to QPR



Suicide Myths & Facts



Myths and Facts About Preventing Suicide

MYTH 1

No one can stop a suicide, it is inevitable.

FACT 1

If people in a crisis get the help they need, they may never be suicidal again.



Myths and Facts About Preventing Suicide

MYTH 2

Asking a person about suicide will only make them angry and increase the risk of suicide.

FACT 2

Asking someone directly about suicidal intent lowers anxiety, opens up communication and lowers the risk of a suicide attempt.



Myths and Facts About Preventing Suicide

MYTH 3

Only experts can prevent suicide.

FACT 3

Suicide prevention is everybody's business, and anyone can help prevent the tragedy of suicide.



Myths and Facts About Preventing Suicide

MYTH 4

People considering suicide keep their plans to themselves.

Most people considering suicide communicate their intent sometime during the week of preceding their attempt.

FACT 4



Myths and Facts About Preventing Suicide

MYTH 5

Those who talk about suicide, do not do it.

People who talk about suicide may try, or even attempt, an act of self-destruction.

FACT 5



Myths and Facts About Preventing Suicide

MYTH 6

Once a person decides to die by suicide, there is nothing anyone can do to stop them.

FACT 6

Suicide is the most preventable kind of death, and almost any positive action may save a life.

A man with dark skin and dreadlocks is shown from the chest up, wearing a dark green bomber jacket over a light-colored t-shirt. He is holding a small, open notebook in his left hand and a white pen in his right hand, appearing to be writing. He is looking off to the side with a thoughtful expression. The background is a blurred outdoor setting with warm, golden light, suggesting late afternoon or early morning.

How can I help?



Suicide Clues and Warning Signs



Take All Signs Seriously.

The more clues and
signs observed,
the greater the risk.



Direct
Verbal Clues



Indirect Verbal
Clues



Behavioral Clues



Situational
Clues

Direct Verbal Clues

- “I’ve decided to kill myself.”
- “I wish I were dead.”
- “I’m going to commit suicide.”
- “I’m going to end it all.”
- “If (such and such) does not happen, I’ll kill myself.”





Indirect Verbal Clues

- “I’m tired of life, I just can’t go on.”
- “My family would be better off without me.”
- “Who cares if I’m dead anyway.”
- “I just want out.”
- “I won’t be around much longer.”
- “Pretty soon you won’t have to worry about me.”



Behavioral Clues

- Any previous suicide attempt
- Acquiring a gun or stockpiling pills
- Co-occurring depression, moodiness, hopelessness
- Putting personal affairs in order
- Giving away prized possessions
- Sudden interest or disinterest in religion
- Drug or alcohol abuse, or relapse after a period of recovery
- Unexplained anger, aggression and irritability





Situational Clues

- Previous suicide attempt
- Being fired or being expelled from school
- A recent unwanted move
- Loss of any major relationship
- Death of a spouse, child, or best friend—especially if by suicide
- Diagnosis of a serious or terminal illness
- Sudden unexpected loss of freedom/fear of punishment
- Anticipated loss of financial security
- Loss of a cherished therapist, counselor or teacher
- Fear of becoming a burden to others

The QPR Institute offers a 3-step intervention plan.

- Approach:
Direct or Indirect
- Identifying
questions to avoid



QUESTION

How do you
persuade someone
to stay alive?



PERSUADE



REFER

How and to whom
will you refer the
person you just
helped?



QUESTION

Asking The Question

ASK THE QUESTION. SAVE A LIFE.

Tips for Asking the Question

- 1 If in doubt, don't wait. Ask the Question!
- 2 If the person is reluctant, be persistent.
- 3 Talk to the person alone in a private setting.
- 4 Allow the person to talk freely.
- 5 Give yourself plenty of time.
- 6 Have your resources handy: the QPR Card, phone numbers, counselor's name and any other information that might help.

REMEMBER:

How you ask the question is less important than that you ask it.





QUESTION

Disrespectful Approach

"Have you been unhappy lately?" upset as you seem to be, they sometimes wish they were dead. very unhappy lately?"

"Have you been very happy lately, that?" you've been thinking about ending your life?"

"I am worried about you. I wonder if you're thinking about suicide?" go to sleep and never wake up?"

"Are you thinking about killing yourself?"

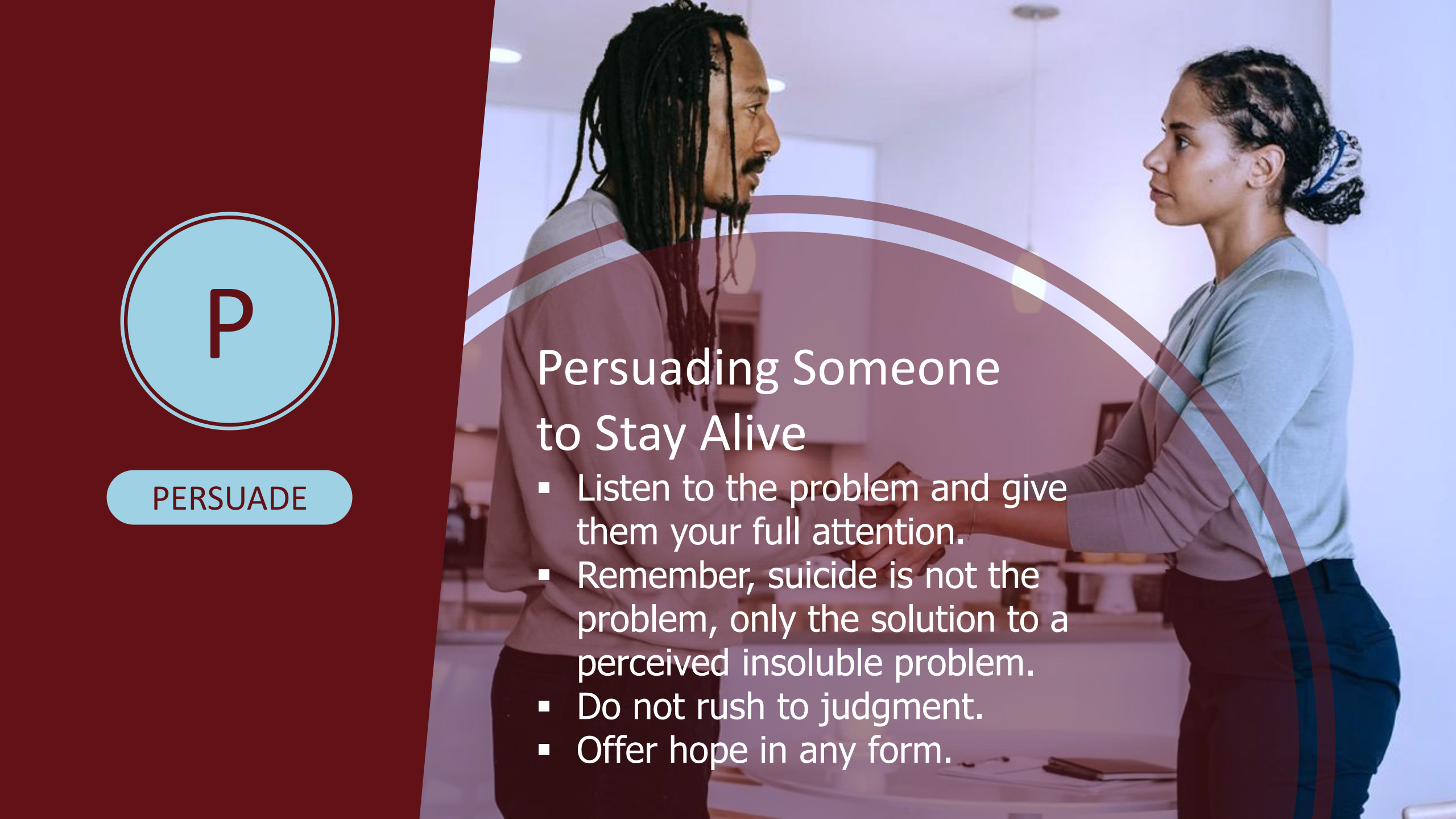
IMPORTANT:

If you cannot ask the question, **find someone who can.**



How **not** to ask the suicide question:

- ✗ "You're not thinking of killing yourself, are you?"
- ✗ "You wouldn't do anything stupid would you?"
- ✗ "Suicide is a dumb idea. Surely you are not thinking about suicide?"



P

PERSUADE

Persuading Someone to Stay Alive

- Listen to the problem and give them your full attention.
- Remember, suicide is not the problem, only the solution to a perceived insoluble problem.
- Do not rush to judgment.
- Offer hope in any form.



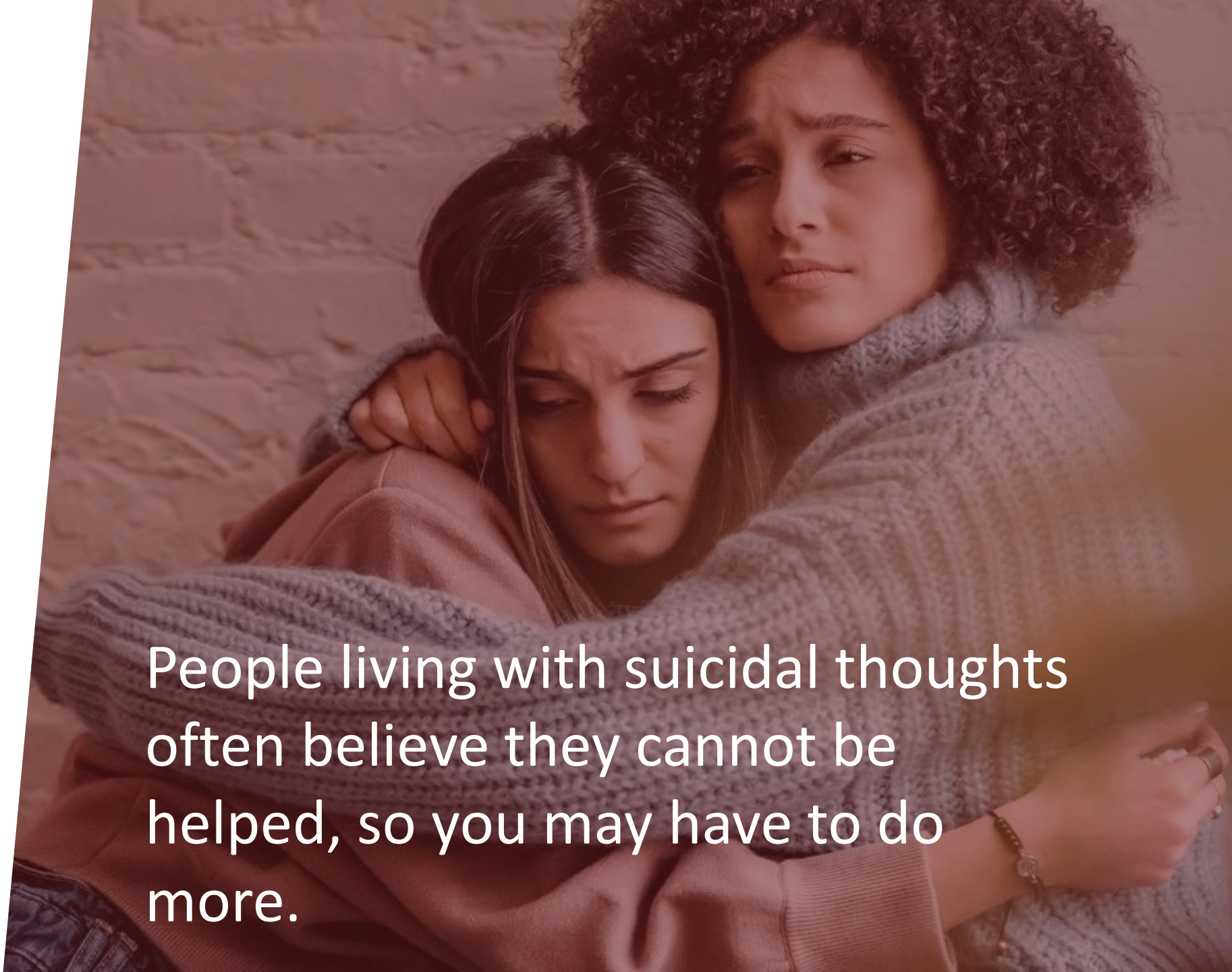
Then, ASK:

- “Will you go with me to get help?”
- “Will you let me help you get help?”
- “What can we do to keep you safe for now?”



REFER

People living with suicidal thoughts often believe they cannot be helped, so you may have to do more.



Referral Options

- ★★★ The **best referral** involves taking the person directly to someone who can help.
- ★★ The **next best referral** is getting a commitment from them to accept help, then making the arrangements to get that help.
- ★ The **third best referral** is to give referral information and try to get a good faith commitment not to attempt or die by suicide.





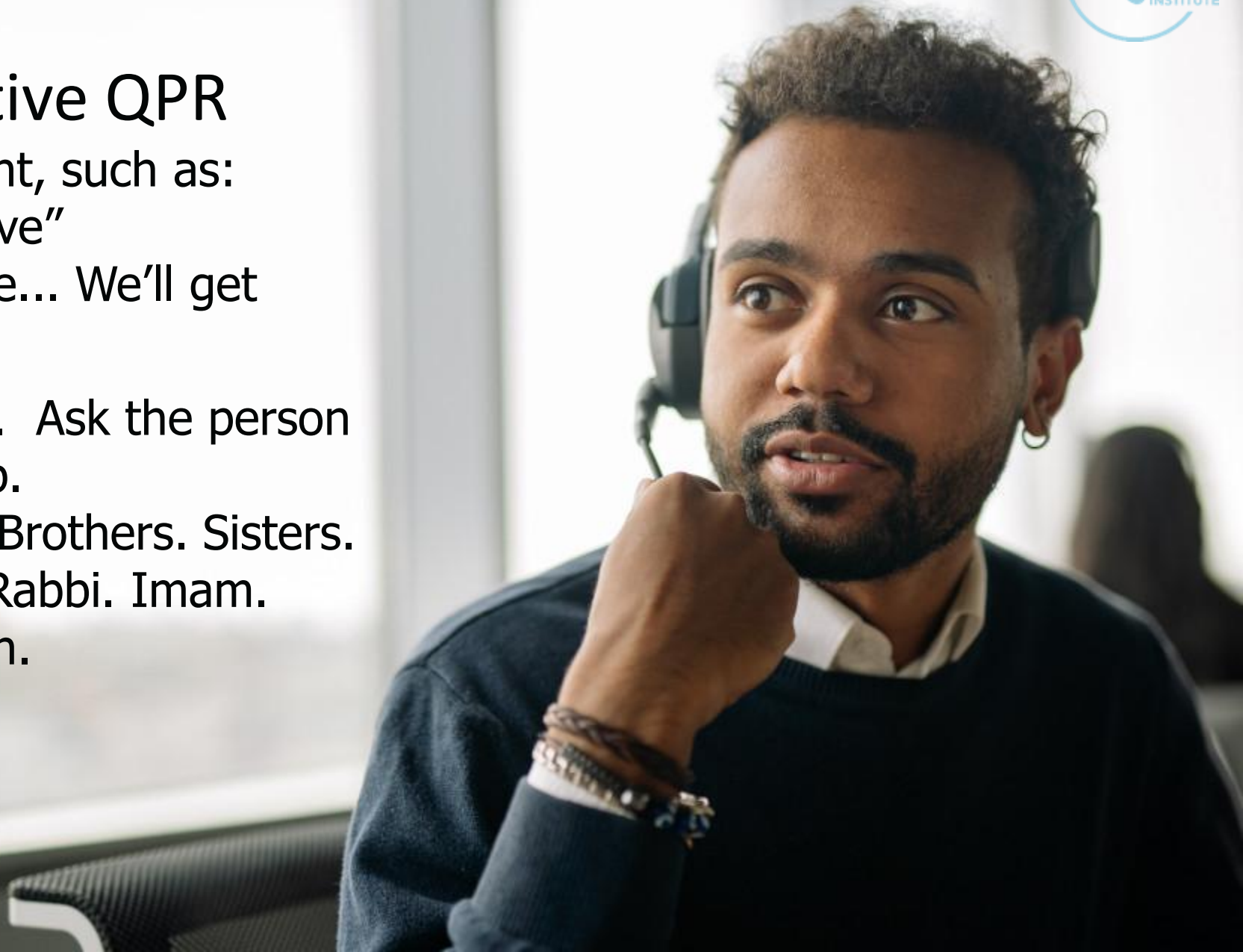
Any willingness to accept help at some time, **even if in the future**, is a good outcome.

REMEMBER:

Since almost all efforts to persuade someone to live instead of attempt suicide will be met with agreement and relief, don't hesitate to get involved or take the lead.

Pro Tips for Effective QPR

- Offer encouragement, such as:
 - "I want you to live"
 - "I'm on your side... We'll get through this."
- Get others involved. Ask the person who else might help.
 - Family. Friends. Brothers. Sisters. Pastors. Priest. Rabbi. Imam. Bishop. Physician.



More Pro Tips

- Join a team. Offer to work with clergy, therapists, psychiatrists or whomever is going to provide the counseling or treatment.
- Follow up with a visit, a phone call or a card, and in whatever way feels comfortable to you.
- Let the person know you care about what happens to them. Caring may save a life.

REMEMBER

When you apply QPR, you plant
the seeds of hope.

Hope helps prevent suicide.



Let's Practice

Online Scenario



Adult Male – Text Only

QPR Practice Session

- Break into pairs
- One person reads the scenario and begins the conversation
- The other person responds with QPR
- This give you the opportunity to practice listening to the problems that cause people to think about suicide and to ask directly about suicide in a frank and compassionate manner.

QPR Practice Session

Reflect to yourself first

- How would you approach this conversation?
- How would you ask about thoughts of suicide?
- What are ways you can empathize with them?
- Who would you refer them to?

Resume

QPR Gatekeeper Training for Suicide Prevention (August, 2025). Completed a professional training workshop from the QPR Institute.

QPR Badge



Post-Training Survey
(next slide)



Post-Training Survey



Contact Information

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Option 4: 24/7 Crisis